A-A-53011
9 June 1987

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SCISSORS, NASAL (Curved, Joseph)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description as a replacement for Military Specification MIL-S-42023(DM), dated 25 September 1986, which is cancelled.

This commercial item description covers a 5-3/4 inch curved nasal scissors of the Joseph design.

Salient characteristics.

Material. Scissors shall be manufactured from Class 4 martensitic corrosion-resistant steel in accordance with American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standard F899.

Hardness. The scissor blades shall have a Rockwell hardness of HRC 50-55.

Style and design. Scissors shall be in accordance with Figure 1. Blade tips shall both be sharp and shall match exactly in the closed position.

Passivation. The scissors shall be properly passivated.

Finish. The finish shall be mirror. The finish shall be uniform and free from cracks, pits, crevices, burrs, and grind or tool marks, and dirt or polishing materials.

Markings. The scissors shall be permanently marked with the manufacturer's name or registered trademark and the word "stainless". In addition, forceps of foreign manufacture shall bear the name of the country of manufacture.

Tests. Scissors shall be tested for corrosion-resistance, hardness, and performance as specified under Quality Assurance Provisions.

SC N/A FSC 6515

STRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; stribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:14Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Workmanship. The scissors shall be processed in such a manner as to be uniform and free from defects which affect life, utility, or appearance.

Product Quality Level

Visual and dimensional examination. Shall be examined to verify that design, construction and workmanship are in accordance with applicable requirements.

Materials. The supplier shall be responsible for performing tests to assure that materials are in accordance with requirements specified.

Unit. Each (EA). One scissors, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Examination. The scissors shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:14Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one scissors. Sampling shall be level S-2, AQL 1.0.

Tests.

Hardness. Rockwell hardness shall be tested in accordance with ASTM Standard E18 or ASTM Standards E92 and E140.

Corrosion-resistance. Scissors shall be tested for corrosion resistance in accordance with the Resistance to Boil and Resistance to Copper Sulfate tests of Federal Specification GG-I-526.

Performance test. The scissors shall be tested in accordance with the scissors performance test of Federal Specification GG-I-526. The test material shall be medium rubber dam in accordance with Federal Specification ZZ-R-690 (see Notes).

The test cuts shall be made using the most distal seventy-five percent of the blade. Any binding or snagging of the test material in the blades shall be a test failure.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specification, standard, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:14Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTES:

NOTE 1: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-01-113-2649	SCISSORS, NASAL, Curved, Joseph, 5-3/4 Inch

NOTE 2: Test material. Size medium rubber dams (dental rubber dams) in accordance with Federal Specification ZZ-R-690 are available from The Hygenic Corporation, Akron, OH.

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

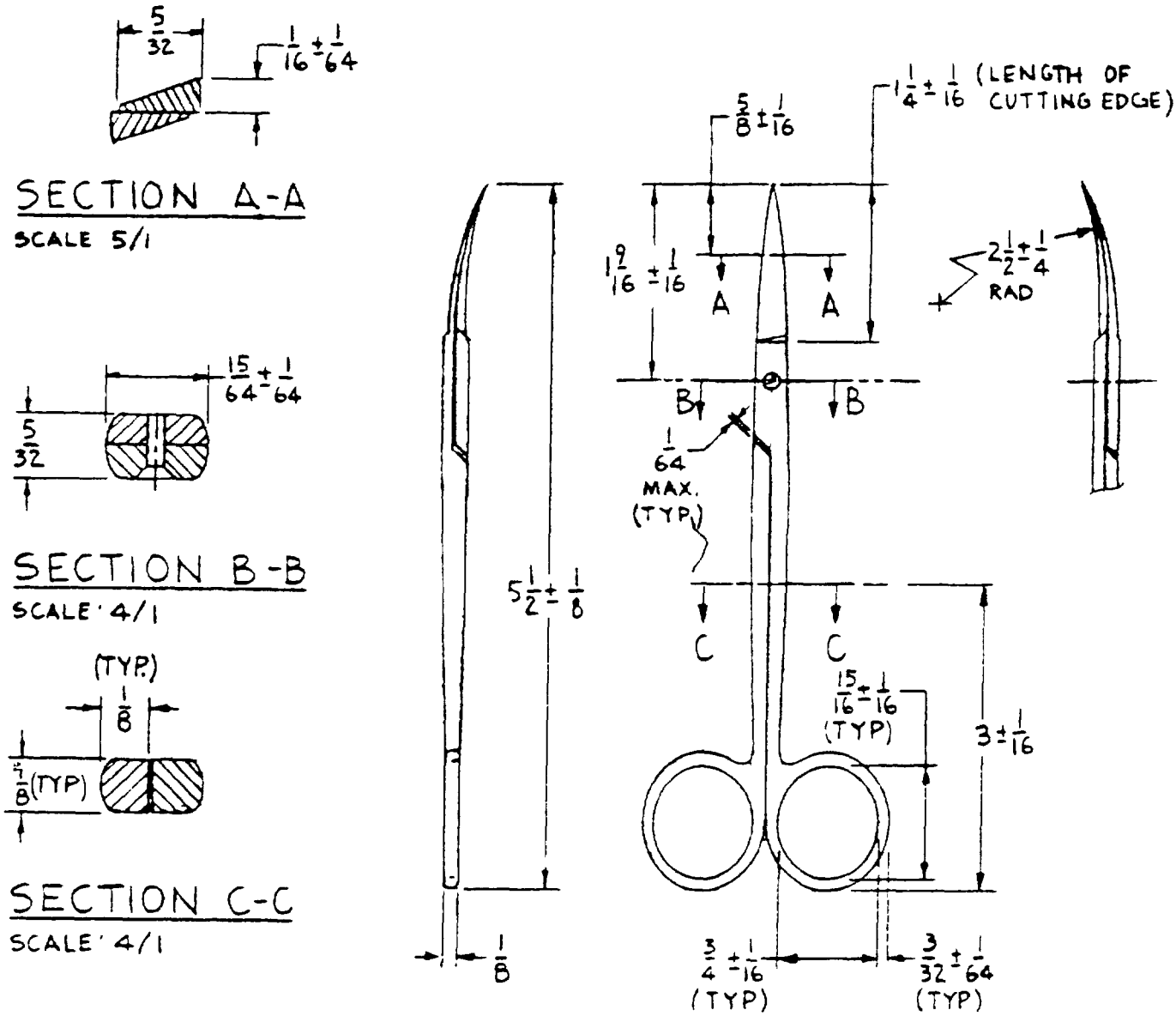
CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PGC 58741

Project No. 6515-4046

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:14Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED DIMENSIONS ARE IN INCHES		
TOLERANCES ON		
FRACTIONS	DECIMALS	ANGLES
± 1/32	±	±

FIGURE 1 SCISSORS, NASAL, CURVED, JOSEPH

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:14Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS. In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE. This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO 4966 WASHINGTON D C

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
ATTN: DPSC-RSTS
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19101-8419

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:14Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53011	SCISSORS, NASAL (Curved, Joseph)

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:14Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.